

Ramkumar Rani

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Results-driven AI/ML & Data leader specializing in enterprise AI strategy, Agentic AI product development, and data-driven transformation in financial services, advisory and regulated industries. Leading KPMG Advisory's AI and Data practice, driving AI-First strategies that boosted AI adoption by 40%+, generated \$15M+ in client revenue, and driven 20–25% efficiency at scale. Deep hands-on expertise in Gen AI, Agentic AI, LLMOps, AI Governance, and Azure data services. Proven building high-performing global teams, C-Suite partnerships, and transitioning prototype to production-scale, cloud-agnostic products that deliver measurable outcomes. Seeking a new role to accelerate and manage enterprise AI transformation. Consistent Learner.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- AI/GenAI/Agentic AI Strategy, Roadmap & Vision
- C-Suite Advisory & Stakeholder Management
- RAG, LLM, VLM & Embedding Models
- Risk Management & Compliance
- AI Enablement & AI-Native Innovation Development
- AI Governance (EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF)
- Cross-Functional Team Leadership
- Financial Services Domain Expertise
- AI Product Development (0 → 1 → Scale), FDE
- Rapid Prototyping & POC-to-Production; LLMOps, DevOps
- Azure AI Foundry & Data Engineering
- Customer/Client Engagement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

KPMG US

Senior Director — Applied AI & Data, Engineering (Forward Deployed Engineering & AI Transformation Lead) | Hybrid / NJ | September 2022 – Present

Client-Embedded AI Transformation & Forward Deployed Delivery

- **Forward Deployed Engineering Leadership:** Lead multi-disciplinary FDE pods embedded on-site with Financial Services clients — translating ambiguous business problems into shipped AI products. Own the full 0→1 lifecycle (discovery → prototype → production), turning around agentic AI POCs in as little as 3 days.
- **Enterprise AI Transformation:** Architected and implemented an AI-First transformation across KPMG Advisory and Fortune-500 clients, improving AI adoption 40%+ and defining multi-year AI vision, strategy and roadmap aligned to business P&L. Drove 20–25% cost-efficiency at scale.
- **C-Suite & Client Partnership:** Embedded directly with CTOs, CIOs and C-Suite executives; acted as connective tissue between business stakeholders and engineering. Established the AI operating model driving sustained top-line growth and bottom-line operational performance.
- **Revenue & ROI:** Led client engagements generating **\$15M+ in revenue** and 18–20% ROI through AI-driven process optimization and prioritization of high-impact use cases. Continuously identified new AI opportunities — KPMG differentiator.
- **Hands-On Technical Leadership:** Architect, code and lead simultaneously. Ship reusable AI capabilities that compound speed for the next engagement; proactively surface risks (with proposed solutions) to Senior Partners and client stakeholders.
- **FDE Team Building:** Built and mentor a 20+ member global matrix FDE / AI & Data team covering Financial Services. Run AI upskilling and knowledge-sharing programs so every engineer can deploy forward with confidence.
- **AI CoE Founder:** Founded and run the KPMG Advisory AI Center of Excellence — vendor management, build-vs-buy, rapid POCs, framework evaluation, technical demos and adoption of emerging AI techniques across the practice.
- **LLM Cost Optimization:** Authored enterprise guidelines for open-source and commercial LLM usage, reducing token consumption costs by 12–18%. Established LLMOps/MLOps standards for rapid prototyping and enterprise-scale rollouts.

Agentic AI Product Delivery (Selected FDE Engagements)

- **Agentic AI Solutions:** Led the architecture and delivery of complex agentic AI solutions driving **20–25% cost-efficiency**, with improved client experience, productivity and risk management. Shipped, not just prototyped.

Agentic AI Contract IQ (Product) — FDE / AI Architecture & Delivery Lead, \$1.5M Initiative

- Owned end-to-end delivery (discovery → post-launch), replacing a costly vendor platform and consolidating disparate KPMG contract systems. Automated ingestion of complex contracts/invoices, leakage detection, fund recovery and labor optimization. **POC delivered in 3 days.**
- Defined the AI product roadmap directly against business outcomes/ROI while embedded with stakeholders.

- RAG metrics: Contextual & Answer Relevancy; agentic loop triggered when Answer Relevancy < 0.85. Full evals + AI Governance built in.
- Ops/Deployment: Azure DevOps CI/CD, Docker containerization on ACR/AKS with WebApps. Cloud-agnostic architecture.
- Stack: Self-corrective RAG, LLMs, Embedding Models, Azure Document Intelligence, PostgreSQL, Azure Cosmos DB, Neo4j, Azure AI Search, React.js, LangChain/LangGraph/LangSmith, Claude Code.
- Impact: **\$200M revenue opportunity**; contract business automation; time-to-value improved substantially vs. incumbent vendor across financials, retail and other verticals.

Agentic AI + MCP Financial Risk Analytics — FDE-Led 0→1 Delivery

- Identified a net-new business opportunity while embedded with a banking client; delivered an agentic AI solution leveraging MCP over bank data with robust evaluation framework and integrated AI Governance.
- Impact: **35% improvement in risk accuracy, 55%+ operational efficiency and \$500K in savings within 6 months.**

RAG Content Harvesting Platform (Product)

- Built and shipped an advanced RAG solution with Flash re-ranker and robust evaluation mechanisms, delivering business-taxonomy insights and thought leadership to KPMG and clients.
- Impact: 100%+ operational efficiency; evolved into a full product generating **\$3M+ revenue over 2 years.**

AI Transformation Enablers: Governance, Platform & Tooling

- **AI Governance:** Designed and implemented an ethical AI governance framework for KPMG and clients, aligned with EU AI Act and NIST AI RMF. Leveraged Credo.ai for Trusted & Responsible AI programs — lowering governance implementation costs 15–20%.
- **LLMOps & CI/CD:** Spearheaded enterprise-scale LLMOps and agent lifecycle management using ADO pipelines, CI/CD, Docker and AKS/ACR. Managed both open-source (Llama) and commercial models (Azure OpenAI, Google Gemini, Anthropic).
- **Azure Data Foundation:** Co-led Azure data pipeline engineering, migration to Microsoft Fabric and data privacy management via Azure Purview, data lineage and data quality frameworks — the substrate every forward-deployed agent runs on.
- **Client-Facing Applications:** Spearhead UI/UX for client-facing apps such as Contract IQ and Fin Insights so deployed agents land in usable products.
- **Developer Tooling & Productivity:** Championed Claude Code for agentic AI development; strategized Azure AI Foundry adoption; leveraged GitHub Copilot and MS Copilot for team-wide productivity. Led fine-tuning of models for domain-specific use cases.

BigR.io

SVP – Data Science | Hybrid/NJ | May 2021 – July 2022

- Strategy and development of BigR.io projects and products – for BigR.io and clients. Built and led a high-performing DS team. Contributed to GTM and Pre-sales. Established the partnership with DataRobot.
- Delivered a predictive modeling for SaaS healthcare payor solution using XGBoosting (on Azure), achieving a F1 score > 0.85. Impact: Revenue stream of \$1M/year. Developed a binary predictive model using Random Forest technique, including feature engg. Resulted in improved prediction stability and accuracy over 30% compared to existing model.
- Ran daily project management (sprint cycle) call for tracking and management.

Credit Suisse (now UBS), Consulting

Data Scientist | NY/NY | Sep 2019 – May 2021

- Delivered enterprise scale Repo, Collateral, and Margin (RCM) trading booking system using Bi-LSTM NER Deep Learning. Achieved F1 score > 0.87. Resulted in saving over \$800K/year. Replaced rule-based trading system. Used by 20+ RCM Credit Suisse/UBS traders.
- Provided DS leadership. Build a solid 10-member DS and data team. Developed MLOps on AWS cloud.

UST

Director, AI / ML | Aliso Viejo, CA/NJ | May 2018 – Sep 2019

- AI/ML Founding Director. Built and mentored a strong global data science team (US & India).
- Managed DS horizontal for UST and clients, resulting in a revenue stream of \$25M.
- Developed and managed UST Flagship product (AutoML) with a revenue base of \$40M. Built a business predictive model for financial client using LSTM. Achieved a superior F1 metric > 0.90.

JP Morgan Chase

Vice President, Global Technology (GT) | NY/NY | Jan 2014 – May 2018

- Initiated ML within GT group. Developed Anomaly Detection using Deep Learning, replace rule-based engine. Developed Risk pricing ML engine using Random Forest; achieved a low MSE, employing a solid hyper-parameter optimization.
- Managed global Ref Data platform on Big Data (Hadoop). Performed Oracle fine-tuning – SQL and DB tuning. Improved Oracle SQL performance by an impressive 75%.

Barclays

Vice President Risk Technology | NY/NY | July 2009 – Jan 2014

- Developed a robust ETL and database backend on Oracle Exadata platform. Support credit, IR, and liquidity risk businesses.
- Hired and managed ~50 member global matrix team: US, UK, India, and Singapore.

[My earlier career in Financials in Wall Street – Citi, Deutsche]

TECHNOLOGY EXPERTISE

- **AI/ML Frameworks:** LangChain, LangGraph, LangSmith, Claude Code, Credo.ai, Hugging Face, PyTorch
- **LLMs & Models:** Azure OpenAI (GPT-4o/5), Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, Meta Llama, VLMs, Embedding Models
- **Cloud & Data:** Azure AI Foundry, Azure Cosmos DB, Azure AI Search, Azure Purview, Microsoft Fabric, PostgreSQL, Neo4j, FAISS
- **DevOps & Infra:** Azure DevOps (ADO), CI/CD Pipelines, Docker, AKS (Kubernetes), GitHub, LLMOps/MLOps
- **Governance:** EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF, Credo.ai, Trusted & Responsible AI, AI Risk Management
- **Frontend/Product:** React.js, UI/UX Design Oversight, Rapid Prototyping

EDUCATION

Master of Science — Computer Science (Minor: Statistics)

Rutgers University, New Brunswick, NJ

KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

- **Forward Deployed Engineer at heart** — embeds with clients, ships fast, iterates in production
- AI leader — Leadership on AI Strategy & Enablement, AI-First, AI-Native development
- Hands-on technical leader — architects, codes, and leads simultaneously
- Entrepreneurial mindset — founded AI CoE; balances innovation with business delivery
- Strong business and technical communication; documentation and vendor management excellence
- Proven track record transitioning POCs to production-grade enterprise AI products
- Financial Services domain focus with deep understanding of risk, compliance, and regulatory AI requirements